

Identity in the Making: Mobile Social Networking App and Identity Work of Organizational Newcomers

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Abstract

Organizational socialization is a transitional event where organizational newcomers engage in identity work. Prior research suggests that social media provide space and opportunities for effective identity work during transitional events. Yet, we know little regarding how they can support such practice during organizational socialization. This study explores how organizational newcomers in China engage in identity work on WeChat. Findings from semi-structured interviews (N=30) suggest that WeChat is used for organizational newcomers' identity learning, primarily through indirect, passive methods such as observation. Identity work includes sharing mundane work life and achievements and forwarding work-related and profession-related information. A flexibility paradox was identified, indicating that newcomers desire an online presence with coworkers while also wanting to withdraw from the demands of being viewed as a good colleague or expert. Thus, this networked performance stifles individualized expressions of newcomers. Implications for organizational socialization research and management and social media design are discussed.

CCS Concepts

• Information systems applications; • Collaborative and social computing systems and tools; • Social networking sites;

Keywords

Organizational socialization, social media, identity work, WeChat, China

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1 INTRODUCTION

Organizational newcomers engage in identity work during organizational socialization, transitioning into new roles that meet expectations from their organizations, coworkers, and occupations [7].

Prior research suggests that social media can be used for effective identity work during transitional events such as adolescence to adulthood and high school to university transition [39], migration to a new city [34], and entering parenthood [2]. However, we know little about how organizational newcomers use social media for identity work during their entry into organizations, specifically in the first six months after joining. More specifically, while there is a growing body of research on organizational socialization via communication technologies, much of the focus has been on enterprise social media. In contrast, WeChat is a public social media platform used by organizational newcomers for both personal and professional communication in China. However, the ways in which these communication tools facilitate or limit organizational socialization have been infrequently examined. Apart from social media's impact on employee engagement and work coordination, which is often found in existing research [9, 14, 32, 46], research suggests that they also bring online identity demands to employees, which means that people need to perform their identities in their employee roles not only offline, in the workplace, but also online, in enterprise and/or public social media [16].

The present study explores organizational newcomers' identity work on social media. Identity work is a process of self-identity sense-making and construction through communication behaviors [1, 28]. Situated in organizational socialization contexts, this study examines how organizational newcomers engage in online identity work while transitioning from outsiders to insiders of their organizations. Specifically, I focus on Chinese organizational newcomers' use of WeChat, the most popular mobile social media in China, during their first six months of employment. This study advances CHI research by investigating how social media design facilitates and limits organizational newcomers in their journey to learn, construct, and establish their identities. Additionally, it expands the scope of social media identity work research to focus on an often-overlooked transitional event—organizational entry—and examines how cultural, organizational, and interpersonal factors influence identity development. Ultimately, it provides insights into social media design that supports adaptable identity work, as well as organizational practices that enhance effective newcomer socialization through social media.

2 LITERATURE REVIEW

2.1 Identity Work during Organizational Socialization

When people transition from outsiders to insiders of an organization, they are likely to encounter questions such as “Who am

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I in this organization or profession?” “What is expected by my coworkers and my organization regarding my performance?” and “How should I act?” In other words, organizational socialization elicits identity work, a process in which people make sense and construct their identities through language and behaviors [1, 29]. Identity work reflects changes in employees’ self-perceptions during transition periods [10]. Ibarra [28] described three stages in identity work: learning from role models, experimenting with a provisional self, and evaluating the experiments based on feedback. Thus, identity work is not only a self-process in which people construct a sense of self but also a communicative process in which people discursively position themselves in their work and life [47].

Research has suggested that organizational newcomers’ identity work is shaped by people and discourses in and outside their organizations [3, 8, 38]. A recent review of identity work suggests that organizational socialization scholars focus largely on role transitions under the influence of institutionalized efforts [8]. From organizations, newcomers obtain information from structured, formal efforts, such as orientation, training sessions, and team-building activities. Through the process of giving needed information to their newcomers, organizations engage in sensegiving, which provides meanings for newcomers’ jobs and roles in the organizations. For organizations, they want their newcomers to identify as part of the organization because such identification can help to improve organizational (e.g., participation, coordination, and employee citizenship behaviors) and individual outcomes (e.g., role clarity, job satisfaction, and social validation) [3–6, 17].

2.2 Identity Work and Social Media: Visibility, Editability, and Persistence in Collapsed Contexts

Although little has been done to explore the identity work of organizational newcomers on social media, research has investigated other transitional life events in the contexts of social media, such as adolescence to adulthood, and high school to university transition [39], migration to a new city [34], and entering parenthood [2]. These studies suggest that social media provide distinctive affordances for identity learning (i.e., resources for identity work) and performance (i.e., ways of doing identity work) in networked contexts.

For identity learning, social media users can observe how others perform their identities without signaling their presence, thanks to the affordance of visibility. Morioka et al. [39] found that disadvantaged college students observed their peers’ college activities and mentor-like figures by following their Facebook accounts and posts, which helped to demystify college life. In organizational contexts, the visibility affordance of social media could enhance the awareness of coworkers as employees read messages from work discussion groups and posts on enterprise social media [31]. The networked contexts of social media, thus, should also help employees, like organizational newcomers, observe how others talk and interact with other coworkers.

For identity performance, social media provide opportunities for people to experiment with their provisional selves and obtain support and feedback from others, which are core tasks that could aid in successful role changes [28]. The editability of content on

social media enables selective self-presentation and asynchronicity [45], which means that people can take time to edit content and post at any time they deem appropriate. Different from self-presentation in offline contexts that is synchronous and limited to people who are present [21], self-presentation on social media is more like an exhibition in which self-related content is curated over time and made available to audience members who are not necessarily present when the content is posted [24]. The affordance of content persistence enables the curation and visibility of content, which enables access to the curated content and the interactions under the post for people who are absent when the content is posted. Similar to identity learning, identity performance is also networked. Context collapse, through which social media users connect to people from various aspects of their lives in one place [35], may facilitate visibility of their identity performance so that people can show their curated content to a broad network, which leads them to receive support and feedback from the various groups of users to which they connect. In the context of transitioning to motherhood, Kumar and Schoenebeck [30] found that this affordance enabled mothers to share positive and fun photos of their babies to perform the identities of a good mother. Since they were connected to people from their different social cycles in one place and social media offered light weighted interactions opportunities (e.g., giving a “like” to a post), mothers could broadcast their life of mothering to and receive validation of their motherhood from broader networks easily.

2.3 Mobile Social Media Use in the Workplace in China

This study focuses on the use of mobile social media, WeChat, by organizational newcomers in China. WeChat is the most popular mobile social media platform in China, and it features an “all in one place” design and is regarded as an infrastructure that supports users’ digital activities daily [48]. Like other social media platforms (e.g., Facebook, Slack, and X), WeChat offers mobile instant text and voice messaging features, voice and video calls, and group chats. It also includes a social networking feature named Moments. Similar to Facebook and X, users on Moments can post original and shared content and interact with other users by liking and commenting on others’ posts. Unlike these platforms, where content can be made available to the whole network, users on Moments have a semi-public network, meaning that posts on Moments are only available to those connected to a user. Users can also block certain users from seeing the posts and limit access to previous posts by only showing posts from the past three days, one month, or six months. Since WeChat has nearly become an essential tool in various aspects of life [41], newcomers might struggle to separate their professional and personal lives if they use WeChat for work purposes. This challenge is further amplified by the difficulty of creating multiple profiles on WeChat, as each mobile phone number is restricted to one profile.

With much scholarly work that focuses on the interpersonal and business implications of WeChat adoption [12, 18], we know little with regard to how it is used for organizational entry. An exception is provided by Guo et al. [22], who explored how employees in international companies in China use WeChat in various phases

of organizational socialization. They suggested that communication visibility and persistence facilitated employees' learning and identity formation, enhancing the socialization efforts of organizations. They also emphasized that the focus on collective culture in China influenced restrictive uses of WeChat, such as limiting self-presentational behaviors and managing boundaries. Huang et al. [25], while not concentrating on organizational newcomers, investigated the use of content visibility features on WeChat Moments. They pointed out the phenomenon of temporal context collapse during transitional events, where the presentation of current and past selves may conflict, challenging identity presentation efforts. The content visibility settings allow users to manage their self-presentation with minimal effort. These studies provide insights for the current study regarding potential contradictions in online identity work during transitional events, as organizational, social, and individual factors contribute to these contradictions. Huang and Zhang [27] found that adding coworkers' WeChat accounts was usually the first thing new employees did on the first day of their work, and it became a norm to use WeChat for instrumental and social exchanges with coworkers. Given its wide adoption in the workplace, organizational newcomers' transition is likely to be affected by the use of WeChat, as other transitional events investigated in the literature.

In sum, the present study explores WeChat use by organizational newcomers for identity work. The literature suggests that when examining identity work in organizational socialization, it is important to look at resources (within and outside of organizations) for identity work, occasions for newcomers' identity learning and adaptation, and the way people see and talk about themselves. Meanwhile, it is of interest to the present study to look at how the use of social media challenges or constrains the identity work of organizational newcomers. Two research questions (RQs) guide this study:

RQ1: How does WeChat provide opportunities for organizational newcomers to conduct (a) identity learning and (b) identity performance?

RQ2: What challenges do organizational newcomers encounter when they do identity work on WeChat?

3 METHODS

Semi-structured in-depth interviews were conducted with organizational newcomers in China. Qualitative interviewing is one of the most frequently used methods in exploratory research that investigates the experience of using technologies such as social media. It allows researchers to gather rich data for deep insights from respondents' reflections on their daily, ordinary activities [23]. Semi-structured interviewing is suitable when scholars are certain about the directions of their investigations but have limited knowledge of the phenomenon. It is a kind of investigation that is "open-ended yet directed, shaped yet emergent, and paced yet unrestricted" [11], which is especially suitable for the present study as organizational socialization using communication technologies is not a brand-new phenomenon and prior work could inform the investigation.

The participants were recruited through snowball sampling. They were full-time employees in mainland China and Hong Kong who just graduated from undergraduate or postgraduate programs.

All the participants had no prior experience of working in their current organizations. This was one of the criteria for participant selection, which precluded the possibility that they might have much knowledge and ongoing organizational identification before joining the organizations for full-time jobs. For the present study, fresh graduates would also provide a lot of insights into their identity changes and identity work because when they start working full-time, they become employees and professionals in some areas. They should experience lots of uncertainty and engage in identity work during this transition, providing an ideal investigation condition.

Upon obtaining ethical clearance, I started recruiting the participants through convenience and snowball sampling. From the authors' personal and professional networks, several potential participants from major cities (Beijing, Shanghai, and Shenzhen) in mainland China were first identified. To increase the diversity of the samples, I purposefully selected contacts from different occupations and locations. To provide a consistent context for our analysis, all interviewees were office workers (e.g., public relations executives, journalists, product designers, and lawyers) who had just started working within six months after graduation from either undergraduate or postgraduate programs in mainland China or Hong Kong.

All the interviews were conducted and transcribed in Mandarin Chinese. A semi-structured interview protocol was adopted. The protocol included four questions to understand the interviewees' work routines and the use of WeChat in general and for work. It also included questions that probed how and what the participants learned from using WeChat about the identities of their organizations and coworkers and how they did identity work on WeChat. Lastly, the participants were asked to reflect on challenges in their experience, such as "Is there anything about your work that you did not wish to present on WeChat, but you have to do so?"

In total, I interviewed 30 participants: 20 female and 10 male, all of whom were office workers. Appendix A.1 presents the background information of the participants. On average, the participants were 22 years old ($SD = 0.81$, ranging from 21 to 24). Employees from seven major cities in mainland China and five from Hong Kong were included. Various industries and positions were represented. Notably, five participants were from Hong Kong. Companies in Hong Kong would generally have different work dynamics and technology use patterns compared to their mainland counterparts. However, this was not the case in this study, as the Hong Kong participants were all originally from mainland China and used WeChat as their primary tool for work-related communication, similar to their mainland colleagues. Therefore, I did not aim to compare participants' experiences from mainland China and Hong Kong in this study.

All the interviews were recorded with the consent of the participants. The recordings were then transcribed and imported to NVivo 12, a qualitative data analysis software. The transcripts were anonymized. Pseudonyms for their names and companies were used. I first open-coded [42] the data to create codes from reading the transcripts. The open codes were created mainly based on the participants' words. Previously identified themes in organizational socialization and technology use research were used as

sensitizing devices and as names of the open codes when appropriate. High-order codes were established to organize the open codes based on the aspects identified in the literature review, such as WeChat functions used for identity presentation, resources for identity presentation and learning, social media affordances (visibility, editability, and persistence), and context collapse. Finally, the codes were further categorized into broader themes: identity learning (RQ1a), identity performance (RQ1b), and challenges (RQ2).

4 FINDINGS

4.1 RQ1a: Learning for Identity Work

One of the frequently mentioned methods of learning identity performance is observation. On WeChat, a user can access another user's previous posts through albums from one's profile page. The album aggregates photos and texts posted in the past. Some participants rely on this affordance of persistence to learn how their coworkers perform their identities. "Once I added my coworkers, I would always go through their posts in the past. It helps me to know about them and understand how they talk about their work," Renee (User Experience Researcher, Beijing) said. In addition to understanding coworkers, reading the post also helped the newcomers understand their organizations' culture. Miley (Financial Consultant, Hong Kong) shared that she felt pride and ambition from her coworkers' past posts. "I learned that in my company, financial consultants are used to show off their achievements and always keep learning knowledge. They present their best selves in Moments," Miley said.

In addition to observing and learning how to construct work identities by themselves, the participants also mentioned that their companies communicated expectations of work identity construction on WeChat. Bailey (English Teacher, Beijing) said that her supervisor suggested that she not say that she was an organizational newcomer or had no overseas experience because she was teaching IELTS and TOEFL, tests of the English language. Since teachers were connected with their students on WeChat, being new and having no overseas experience would undermine her expert image. Miley (Financial Consultant, Hong Kong) was asked to post product-related information to WeChat Moments. Her company provided templates (pictures and texts) she could copy and paste to her Moments, and her supervisor would send the templates to work groups, and the consultants would then post them to WeChat Moments. From these examples, WeChat is a place for the participants to learn the ongoing identity construction of their coworkers. Moreover, employers try to regulate their employees' work identity construction in this space, ensuring they are aligned with the organizational expectations.

4.2 RQ1b: Identity Performance - Working on Personae (Ren She)

The interview data suggests that organizational newcomers experimented with their provisional identities on WeChat, most of which occurs in WeChat Moments. Using the participants' words, they worked to create personae ("ren she" in Chinese) through posts in WeChat Moments. Ren she is an online identity image created in accordance with existing organizational norms. Establishing ren she has become an essential aspect of our participants' experiences

during their organizational socialization. Details of mundane, everyday work life and accomplishments were the most commonly mentioned content for identity construction.

The personae might not reflect their true selves but provisional ones. Timothy (Marketing Executive, Tianjin) stated that, in WeChat Moments, he loved his work much more than he did in reality. Bailey (English Teacher, Beijing) reflected that she was more positive and extroverted in WeChat Moments posts than in real life. Considering that organizational newcomers are transitioning, projecting self-images inconsistent with their true selves is understandable. But an important point here is that the provisional selves might not be what the participants truly wished themselves to become but were constructed as a result of understanding and catering to what was expected by their employers.

On WeChat, newcomers experimented with their provisional identities with considerations of time and the audience of their identity work. The interview data suggests that newcomers' leaders and professional identification influenced the construction. As another example, Paula (Public Relations Account Executive, Hong Kong) posted a picture showing that she worked until midnight in the office and said, "This is how our director and program executives work and why we are excellent." In such a post, Paula appealed to what the communication professionals would believe were normal practices. By showing that she worked so late, she also received support from her coworkers and leaders in the form of likes and comments on the post. "But I really think it's not a good idea to 'OT' (work overtime). I posted this because I want my coworkers, especially my supervisor, to see how hardworking I am and maybe let us have less OT," said Paula.

As for feedback on identity work, the participants mentioned that they received one-click responses such as "likes" and comments to posts from their peers and supervisors. "It's like a recognition of your identity when you see your coworkers like your posts. When I post the late-night OT message, I expect a 'like' or a thumbs up from my manager," Paula (Public Relations Account Executive, Hong Kong) said. In addition to online responses, offline interactions also give newcomers a sense of recognition. Iris (User Interface Designer, Beijing) shared that her manager saw her Moments posts about some design insights and chatted about them when he saw her in the lift. "I didn't know he would see this because he disliked or commented on the posts. But he mentioned them the next day when we bumped into each other. I was surprised, but I was also glad that he saw that because it showed his recognition of my expertise," Iris said.

4.3 RQ2: Flexibility Paradox

RQ2 asked about the challenges organizational newcomers faced in identity work on WeChat. From the interviews, the participants indicated that their perception of WeChat had changed since starting working. To the participants, WeChat changed from a personal to a professional-personal communication tool since they started working as full-time employees. They indicated that managing such change and the associated identity work was one of the most important aspects of organizational socialization.

The interview data suggests that contradictory forces can be conceptualized as a flexibility paradox. Although organizational

newcomers can technically choose whatever content they want and send posts at any time and any place, feedback from coworkers and supervisors and organizational norms contribute to a chilling effect through which newcomers have little flexibility in their identity work. Organizations express high demand for social media identity from their newcomers. I term this contradictory feeling a flexibility paradox. The editability afforded by WeChat Moments allows users to construct and control their self-images on Moments. However, the flexibility of content construction is constrained by the expectations of a relatively rigid identity image expressed by organizations or observed through organizational newcomers' previous posts on Moments.

Experimentation of identities should allow a certain level of flexibility. Although provisional identity is assumed to help people establish new identities, it does not mean that people always welcome provisional identities, especially considering that coworkers or organizations enforce such identities. As veteran employees may share similar, stable work identity presentations on WeChat, newcomers have to perform as their coworkers even if they wish to deviate in their self-presentations and present different identities because the organizationally and socially accepted identity does not represent their authentic selves. This echo chamber effect [33] may lead them into a paradoxical situation in which they have to align their identity presentations with their coworkers' and organizations', which is not necessarily beneficial for their organizational socialization [10]. The flexibility paradox means that organizational newcomers wish to have an online presence with their coworkers but at the same time wish to withdraw from the ongoing networked performance of "a good colleague and coworker," "a good employee," or "an expert." In this sense, the networked performance silences certain individualized performances of organizational newcomers. As a result, organizational newcomers experience identity asymmetry [37]. That is, they feel that the identity perceived by others is not favored and consistent with their true selves.

The participants adopted boundary management strategies in response to the flexibility paradox. A common one is to set a temporal boundary of the content on Moments. Almost all the participants said they would only allow others to view their posts from the past three days or the last half a year. This setting would allow them to reduce the possibility of awkward encounters of posts in the past that may suggest identities greatly deviant from their current identity presentations. Benson (Account Executive, Zhuhai) elaborated that such temporal boundary management would give him more control without deleting the content. "You don't need to worry that your colleagues might see how crazy you are when you are a university student."

Maintaining separate groups can be tricky because the contact list grows over time during organizational entry, and the participants must constantly manage the audience groups. Accidentally posting content to out-groups was common. Stephanie (Internal Communication Executive, Shenzhen) gave an example. She posted her vacation photos on Moments, wishing to leave her colleagues out of the audience. But she forgot to include a newly connected colleague in the work-related audience group. When she saw the comment from her colleague, she was shocked and deleted the post immediately.

5 CONCLUDING DISCUSSIONS

This study adds to the growing body of research on how social media may enable and constrain identity work during transitional events [13, 34]. While social media could enable identity work, it may also constrain the process when organizational norms, the online presence of coworkers, and organizational socialization tactics (e.g., templates for self-promotion) contribute to rigidity in identity work. In this case, organizational newcomers may experience identity asymmetry [37] and engage in organizational, skill-based identities [10] in which they feel that their organizations expect them to construct identities not in line with what they would see themselves. In such situations, when newcomers unwillingly engage in identity construction to meet expectations or perform catering [20], they are likely to feel exhausted and trapped.

This study contributes to CHI research in the following ways. First, this study contributes a paradoxical perspective in understanding social media use and outcomes. Extending previous work on the paradox of mobile social media uses [19, 26, 36], it proffers a flexibility paradox that accounts for the contradictions in identity work on social media. The paradox triggers meaning-making processes where employees make sense of what it means by using the technologies, especially those adopted in the employees' social and private lives. One interesting area for future research is how organizational newcomers account for their technology use pattern changes during organizational entry. In this study, part of the organizational newcomers' identity work is found to be related to how they learn and explain the implications of using WeChat as professionals. It is not only the resources and performance they find on WeChat but also the meaning of using WeChat as working professionals that characterize changes people experience in organizational socialization nowadays. As organizations are increasingly adopting communication technologies for work, understanding how newcomers make sense of technological frames [40], assumptions of technologies of their organizations and coworkers would be theoretically and practically interesting and has the potential to extend existing work that looks only at how employees make sense of newly introduced technologies in organizations.

Second, this study illuminates how social media design offers opportunities for identity work in a relatively under-explored context: organizational socialization through public social media. The identified flexibility paradox suggests that communication visibility and persistence aid organizational newcomers' identity learning and expression; however, they also restrict their identity work as organizations and managers leverage it to keep newcomers "under the radar." In this respect, this study resonates with recent research indicating that while communication visibility may encourage open dialogue, it can also reinforce the power hierarchy in Chinese organizations [43]. Here, organizational newcomers face pressure to engage in identity work that does not necessarily align with their authentic selves but rather with prescribed self-identities. Therefore, social media affordances may be a double-edged sword for employees. Instead of solely examining the action possibilities provided by social media affordances, scholars should focus on investigating the contradictions these affordances create and the

organizational and individual factors that shape these contradictions. This will lead us to a more nuanced understanding of social media uses in organizational contexts.

Finally, this study provides implications for organizational practices of sensegiving and social media design. For Chinese organizations, since WeChat has become an inevitable communication tool for work, to help their newcomers during their organizational entry better, organizations need to consider how to communicate their expectations of technology use and provide discourses of the organizations, work, and jobs so that employees can engage in identity work that helps them establish identification with the organizations and the job. Organizational tactics should allow flexibility of new employees' self-presentation on social media rather than providing rigid templates for the employees to follow.

The findings of the present study also suggest some design opportunities. One of the implications of the present study is that organizational newcomers indirectly access information from their coworkers and leaders on WeChat groups and Moments to make sense of expectations of identity work during organizational entry. In order to facilitate such identity learning, social media can address newcomers' needs by providing features that can help newcomers filter, locate, and extract information about their work-related contacts more easily and quickly. For instance, Moments can add a feature that allows users to view posts from a specific group of contacts only, which will help new organizational members quickly understand the identity work of their colleagues. One of the challenges of boundary management on WeChat identified in this study was the collapse of the temporal context. Adding new connections to contact lists may create complications for identity work as the new contact might have direct access to curated identity images from the past. WeChat has the potential to enhance profile-building capabilities by enabling users to incorporate diverse elements into their self-representations. At present, profiles are limited to just a photo and text. The platform could introduce curated albums, allowing users to select and tailor different self-images for various audiences. This feature would assist newcomers within an organization in crafting the ideal first impressions for their newly established work connections.

Some limitations of this study should be noted. First, the participants mostly come from first-tier cities in China and are knowledge workers, which may limit the generalizability of the findings. Knowledge workers have different work arrangements from other workers (e.g., service workers, [44]). Comparative research could be conducted to explore how work arrangements provide distinctive conditions for organizational socialization. Secondly, this study only focuses on fresh graduates' organizational socialization and use of WeChat. As suggested by the findings, they experienced a significant identity transition from students to working professionals. The transition might not be necessarily critical or filled with much uncertainty if we consider working professionals' transition into a new job role or in a new company. Nevertheless, this is also a kind of organizational socialization that includes learning, adjustment, and identity performance [15]. Future research could look at how social media plays a role in such situations. Thirdly, this study draws on mostly organizational newcomers' accounts and their experience of using social media. In other words, I largely rely on the participants' perceptions rather than actual behaviors.

To overcome this limitation, content analysis could be employed to examine organizational newcomers' social media posts during their entry to new organizations to provide more concrete data for their identity work.

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A APPENDICES

A.1 Participant Information

The participant information includes pseudonyms, sex (F=female, M=male), city, job title, industry, and types of organizations.

1. Alicia, F, 22, Qingdao, Public Relations Executive, Science and Technology Service, Mixed (state-owned and private)
2. Alvin, M, 22, Qingdao, Officer, Government, Government
3. Benson, M, 21, Zhuhai, Account Executive, Advertising, Private
4. Bailey, F, 22, Beijing, English Teacher, Education, Private
5. Donald, M, 21, Shenzhen, Programmer, Information Technology, Mixed (state-owned and private)
6. Felicia, F, 22, Beijing, Marketing Executive, Media, State-owned
7. Fiona, F, 23, Haikou, Officer, Government, Government
8. Frank, M, 22, Shenzhen, Journalist, Media, State-owned
9. Gloria, F, 24, Shenzhen, Teaching Assistant, Education, State-owned
10. Gary, M, 22, Zhuhai, Project Assistant, Advertising, Private and multinational
11. Helen, F, 21, Zhuhai, Account Executive, Advertising, Private and multinational
12. Iris, F, 21, Beijing, User Interface Designer, Information Technology, Mixed
13. Julie, F, 23, Beijing, User Interface Designer, Information Technology, Private
14. Kevin, M, 21, Qingdao, Lawyer, Legal Industry, Private
15. Lake, M, 22, Qingdao, Teacher, Education, Private
16. Lotus, F, 22, Beijing, Production Assistant, Media, State-owned
17. Lily, F, 23, Shenzhen, Product Assistant, Information Technology, Mixed
18. Miranda, F, 21, Haikou, Internal Communication Executive, Industrial Conglomerate, State-owned
19. Miley, F, 23, Hong Kong, Financial Consultant, Insurance and Financial Consulting, Multinational
20. Nick, M, 22, Hong Kong, Financial Consultant, Insurance and Financial Consulting, Multinational
21. Olivia, F, 22, Hong Kong, Account Executive, Public Relations, Multinational
22. Paula, F, 21, Hong Kong, Account Executive, Public Relations, Multinational
23. Quinine, F, 22, Hong Kong, Financial Consultant, Insurance, Multinational
24. Renee, F, 23, Beijing, User Experience Researcher, Information Technology, Private
25. Rebecca, F, 22, Qingdao, Human Resources Assistant, Hotel, Multinational
26. Sabrina, F, 21, Shenzhen, Account Executive, Public Relations, Multinational
27. Stephanie, F, 21, Shenzhen, Internal Communication Executive, Industrial Conglomerate, State-owned
28. Stella, F, 22, Shanghai, Multimedia Content Editor, Online Media, Private
29. Tim, M, 22, Shanghai, Account Executive, Public Relations, Multinational

30. Timothy, M, 23, Tianjin, Marketing Executive, Sugar Industry,
State-owned